

Adverse Media Review Guidelines

1. Purpose

Adverse media review identifies negative news coverage that may indicate reputational, financial or legal risk associated with a prospective client.

2. Search Approach

Searches cover the legal entity name, known trade names and identified Ultimate Beneficial Owners across the preceding seven years of publicly available reporting.

3. Materiality Assessment

Not all adverse media is material. Analysts assess relevance, recency, credibility of the source and whether allegations relate to financial crime, fraud or regulatory sanction.

4. Result Recording

The outcome is recorded as Clear, Hit or PendingReview on the case's KYCAssessment record, along with a short rationale for the determination.

5. Escalation Threshold

Any adverse media indicating a criminal conviction, regulatory enforcement action or credible fraud allegation is escalated to compliance regardless of the case's current risk rating.